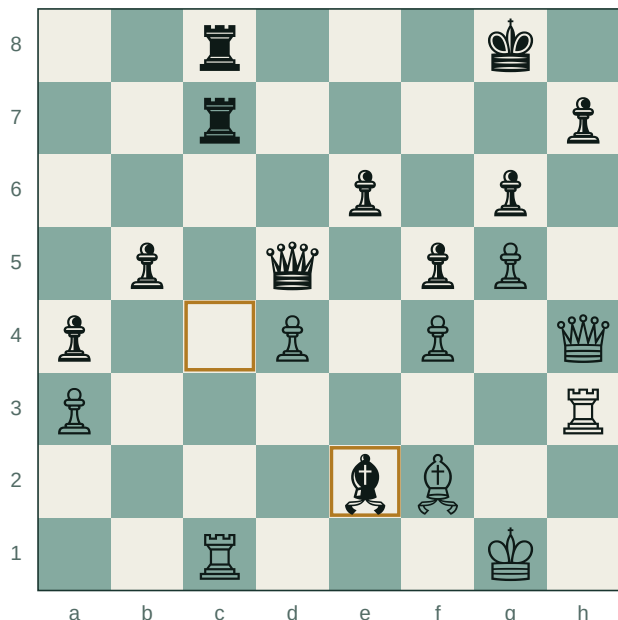


Deflection tactics: White, move 35

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Be2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qxh7+ Rxh7 36. Rxc8+ Kg7 37. Rc7+

35.Qxh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From h7 it attacks king on g8 and rook on c7. Recorded reply: **35...Rxh7**.

36.Rxc8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on c8. Recorded reply: **36...Kg7**.

37.Rc7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -3: the balance goes from -2 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e2. Check for tactical protection.